WORD rsidR COLORIZER

User's Guide

For Forensic Examiners and Investigators

Version 1.4
November 5, 2026

VALIDATE YOUR FINDINGS
RSID-based attribution is corroborative, not conclusive. Always validate material findings against the underlying OOXML, especially **word/document.xml**.

1. Introduction

1.1 What This Tool Does

Microsoft Word stores revision save identifiers (RSIDs) in OOXML. The Word rsidR Colorizer reads **w:rsidR** values from a .docx file and lets an examiner assign colours to visible text associated with those values. Text linked to the same revision-save identifier can then be reviewed visually and saved as an analytical copy.

The application deliberately focuses on **w:rsidR**. It does not use w:rsidP, w:rsidRPr, or w:rsidDel as substitutes for the session identifier attached to visible text.

1.2 Effective rsidR Handling in v1.4

For a visible run, v1.4 first uses the run's explicit **w:rsidR**. If the run has no w:rsidR, the application uses the containing paragraph's **w:rsidR**. This same rule is now used by the preview, report, and save process.

> **FIX IN VERSION 1.4**
> Version 1.3 could show paragraph-inherited text in colour in the preview/report but leave that text unchanged in the saved DOCX. Version 1.4 corrects the save routine so the output follows the same effective-rsidR logic.

1.3 Investigational Value

The tool is useful when comparing disputed text with text an individual acknowledges writing. Shared rsidR values can support an editing-session hypothesis, but they do not by themselves identify a human author.

• Colour isolated to disputed text can be consistent with a separate editing session.

• The same colour appearing across disputed and acknowledged text can indicate a shared revision-save session and may warrant further inquiry.

2. Recommended Workflow

Report first, colourize second. This reduces trial and error and provides a reproducible path from rsidR mapping to saved analytical output.

• Open the source .docx.

• Generate an RSID report and identify the rsidR value(s) associated with text of interest.

• Use the filter box or scrollbar to locate those values in the left pane.

• Assign colours and review the preview.

• Save a colourized copy. A colourization log is created automatically.

• Validate material findings directly in word/document.xml.

> **TIP**
> Retain the source document, examination log, RSID report, colourized output, and colourization log together so another examiner can reproduce the workflow.

3. Application Interface

3.1 Opening a Document

Select **Open Document** and choose a .docx file. The application computes the source hash information, extracts document metadata, identifies active rsidR values, builds the preview, and creates an examination log.

3.2 rsidR Values Pane

The left pane lists active rsidR values in descending occurrence count. Each row shows the hexadecimal rsidR value, occurrence count, colour swatch, and Reset control.

Version 1.4 keeps a **vertical scrollbar** visible on the right edge of this pane. You can use it or the mouse wheel to reach values below the visible area.

3.3 Filtering

Type part or all of an rsidR value in the Filter box. Matching is case-insensitive and updates as you type. The clear control restores the full list. Filtering changes visibility only; it does not discard assigned colours.

4. Colorizing rsidR Values

4.1 Applying and Removing Colour

Select a row's colour swatch or rsidR label to open the colour picker. Assign different colours to different rsidR values as needed.

• Reset removes the assignment for one rsidR value.

• Clear All removes all current colour assignments.

• The preview updates immediately after an assignment changes.

4.2 Preview and Saved Output

The preview and save routine now use identical effective-rsidR resolution: **run rsidR first, paragraph rsidR second**. This is important for Word XML where visible runs omit w:rsidR but their containing paragraph carries the relevant value.

> **IMPORTANT**
> A non-zero rsidR occurrence count does not guarantee visible coloured text. Some revision identifiers may relate to structure or formatting rather than a text-bearing run.

5. Saving and Logs

5.1 Saving a Colourized Document

Use **Save** or **Save As...** to write the analytical copy. The application replaces word/document.xml in a copy of the package and leaves the source file unchanged.

5.2 Colourization Log

The colourization log records source and output file details and hashes, original metadata, assigned rsidR values, selected hex/RGB colours, and an affected-occurrence summary. Retain this log with the case work product.

6. Generating an RSID Report

Generate Report creates a Word document that maps active rsidR values to extracted text. Each section identifies the rsidR value and lists page number, paragraph number, and associated text segments.

Page-number mapping uses Microsoft Word automation through pywin32. When Word automation is unavailable, the report can still be produced but page numbers may be unavailable.

7. Best Practices and Limitations

• Validate important findings against raw OOXML.

• Treat RSID analysis as corroborative rather than definitive authorship attribution.

• Use the report-first workflow to minimize trial and error.

• Retain hashes and logs to support reproducibility.

• Do not assume every rsidR represents newly typed visible text.

• Keep the original evidence file unchanged and distinguish analytical colourized copies from evidence.

8. Version 1.4 Change Summary

Change	Version 1.4 behaviour
Saved colours	Paragraph-inherited rsidR values are now colourized when appropriate.
Consistency	Preview, report, and save use the same run-then-paragraph effective rsidR rule.
rsidR pane	Vertical scrollbar is packed before the expanding canvas so it remains visible.
Documentation	Guide and README describe the corrected behaviour and scrolling.

End of User Guide - Word rsidR Colorizer v1.4